RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

21 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 11:55 PM, Wednesday 21 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 373 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 73 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 14,551 minutes at 12:00 AM (one delayed landing since 9:00 PM); Dammam moving after halts 8:54 to 9:48 PM and 9:56 to 10:55 PM

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INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 14,551 minutes at 12:00 AM; NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight**.
- Since 9:00 PM Riyadh logged no takeoffs and one landing, delayed Saudia SV993 from Shenzhen at 10:49 PM; 373 Wednesday Riyadh flights cancelled (59%).
- Energy Ministry: drone aimed at Aramco's Shaybah field intercepted Wednesday morning; falling debris killed 2 residents and injured 2.
- US State Department warns Houthi attacks on Saudi airports and infrastructure could escalate; posts citing Reuters say the US is preparing ordered departures from Gulf embassies (unverified).
- Dammam airport moving after two evening halts (8:54 to 9:48 PM and 9:56 to 10:55 PM); 2 takeoffs and 4 landings since 9:00 PM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (14546 min).

373	0/0	9
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

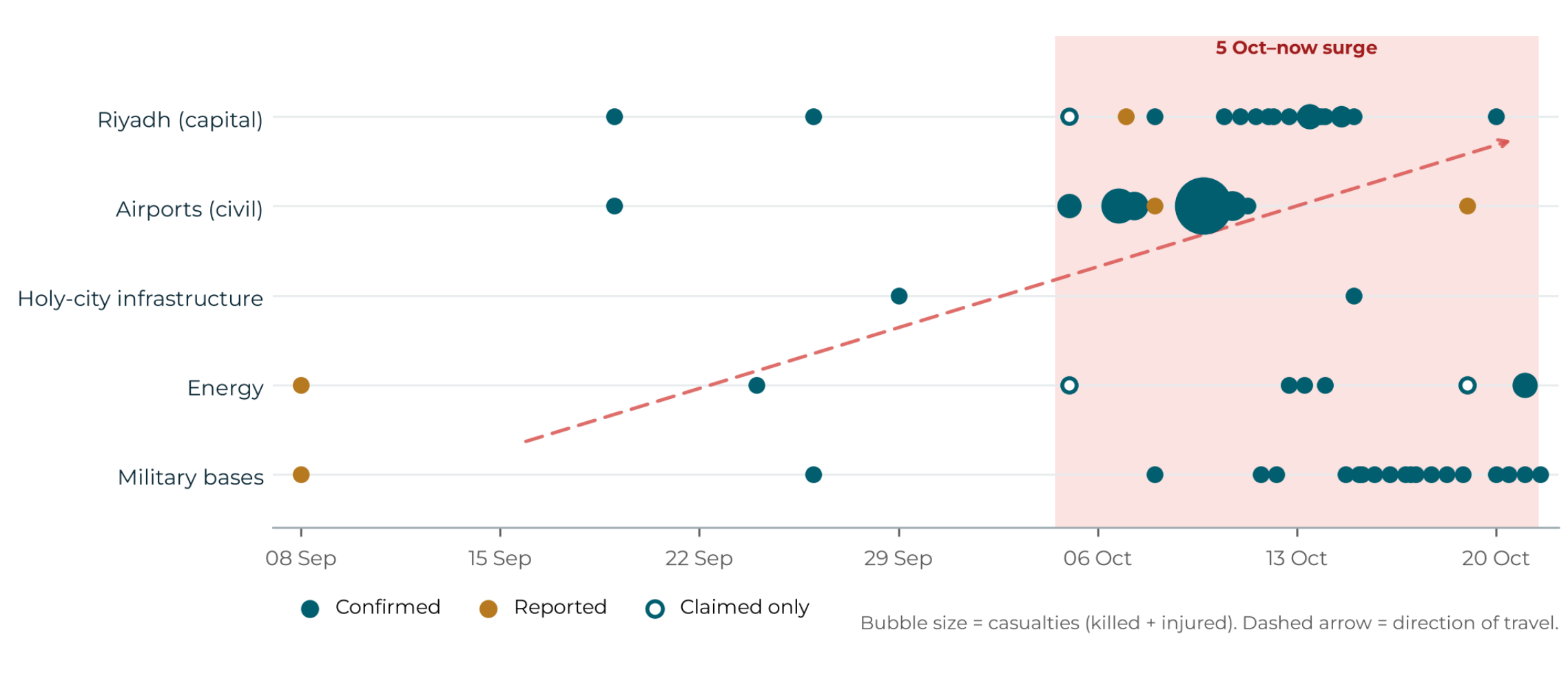
2 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour.

73	2/1	1
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (13,830 min at 12:00 PM); no takeoffs or landings since the 9:00 AM edition
- No new attack, interception or Civil Defense alert reported in Saudi Arabia since 9:00 AM
- Yemen's central bank in Aden ordered assets of 135 Houthi-linked people, entities and ships frozen (10:28 AM)
- Iran says Saudi Arabia has not answered its offer to mediate with the Houthis (Al Arabiya English, 10:01 AM; claim)
- Dammam moving with no halt; 9 takeoffs and 9 landings since 9:00 AM

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 21 OCT



58 sourced events since 8 September (50 confirmed). Latest: Ministry of Energy (announced 10:08 PM): a drone aimed at a facility in Aramco's Shaybah field was intercepted on Wednesday morning; falling debris killed 2 residents (Filipino, Nepali) and injured 2 (Pakistani, Indian), and a contractor vehicle caught fire (21 Oct, Ministry of Energy via SPA; 2 killed, 2 injured). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

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ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 9:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED INTERCEPTION **10:08 PM AST · Eastern Region**

Ministry of Energy (announced 10:08 PM): a drone aimed at a facility in Aramco's Shaybah field was intercepted on Wednesday morning; falling debris killed 2 residents and injured 2 (Pakistani, Indian), and a contractor vehicle caught fire. Ministry of Energy via SPA · 2 killed, 2 injured

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 4.

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NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Riyadh still halted; drone debris near Shaybah field kills 2; US travel warning; Dammam moving after two evening halts

Checked at 11:55 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh: private water tank collapse floods streets near a university; Civil Defense says it was accidental**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) **· 10:31 PM** · published 10:31 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (official account); checked 11:55 PM

Al Ekhbariya said a privately owned water tank near the University of Business and Technology collapsed, sending water into the university car parks and nearby streets. Civil Defense's initial statement said the collapse was accidental, and traffic returned to normal by 10:32 PM.

CONFIRMED **Crown Prince receives a written message to King Salman from the Egyptian President**

Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) **· 10:11 PM** · published 10:11 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (official account); checked 11:55 PM

The Foreign Ministry said Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman received a written message addressed to the Custodian of the Two Holy Mosques from Egyptian President Abdel Fattah el-Sisi. Contents were not given.

CONFIRMED **Ministry of Energy: drone aimed at a Shaybah field facility intercepted; falling debris killed 2 residents and injured 2**

SPA (@Spa_Eng) **· 10:08 PM** · published 10:08 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (official account; Arabic SPA 9:57 PM); checked 11:55 PM

The Ministry of Energy said air defences intercepted a drone on Wednesday morning that tried to target a facility at Aramco's Shaybah field in the Eastern Province. Falling debris killed two residents (a Filipino and a Nepali) and injured two (a Pakistani and an Indian), and a contractor's vehicle caught fire outside the facility.

UNVERIFIED **Reuters, relayed on X: US preparing ordered departure of non-emergency staff and families from Gulf embassies**

Reuters via @osinthexagone **· 10:01 PM** · posted 10:01 PM AST Wed 21 Oct; Reuters article not checked directly; checked 11:55 PM

Accounts on X citing Reuters say the State Department is preparing an ordered departure of non-emergency personnel and family members from Gulf posts, citing possible renewed Houthi attacks. No State Department announcement yet.

CONFIRMED **US State Department travel advisory: Houthi attacks on Saudi civilian airports and infrastructure could escalate**

US State Dept (@TravelGov) **· 9:31 PM** · published 9:31 PM AST Wed 21 Oct; checked 11:55 PM

The US State Department said Iranian-supported Houthis have attacked civilian airports and other critical infrastructure in Saudi Arabia, causing civilian casualties and severe travel disruption, and warned the hostilities could escalate. A US Mission update relayed on X says Riyadh airport operations remain suspended while Jeddah and Dammam operate with some delays and cancellations.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport again gives no reopening date, refers travellers to the authorities and their airline**

King Khalid International Airport (@KKIASA) **· 8:36 PM** · replies posted 7:08 PM and 8:36 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (translated from Arabic); checked 8:50 PM

Replying to travellers, the official Riyadh airport account again said that for airspace updates they should follow the official competent authorities or the airline they booked with. No date for scheduled flights to resume was given.

CONFIRMED **Council of Senior Scholars: the Houthi militia is a terrorist group; attempts to target the Two Holy Mosques are terrorism**

SPA (@SPAregions) / Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) **· 8:33 PM** · published 8:33 PM (SPA) and 8:39 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (translated from Arabic); checked 8:50 PM

Saudi Arabia's top religious body said the Houthis' targeting of civilians in Yemen and their 'sinful attempt to target the Two Holy Mosques' is terrorism by every measure. It follows the coalition's report earlier today of drones intercepted over the Madinah region.

CONFIRMED **French President Macron leaves Riyadh after meeting the Crown Prince**

SPA (@SPAregions) / Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) **· 7:12 PM** · published 7:12 PM (SPA) and 7:15 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (translated from Arabic); SPA English 7:09 PM on the talks; checked 8:50 PM

SPA said the French President left Riyadh, seen off by the Deputy Emir of the Riyadh Region, after he and the Crown Prince discussed strategic ties and regional developments. His state flight is not on the airline boards.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: Houthi drone launched toward the Southern Region intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki al-Malki, via Al Arabiya English / Arab News **· 7:08 PM** · Al Arabiya English 7:08 PM AST Wed 21 Oct; Arab News 7:40 PM; checked 8:50 PM

The coalition spokesman said a drone launched by the Houthis toward Saudi Arabia's Southern Region was intercepted and destroyed. No damage or casualties were reported. Al Arabiya added at 7:23 PM that the coalition has intercepted five drones on Wednesday, including over the Madinah region.

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KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (14546 min).

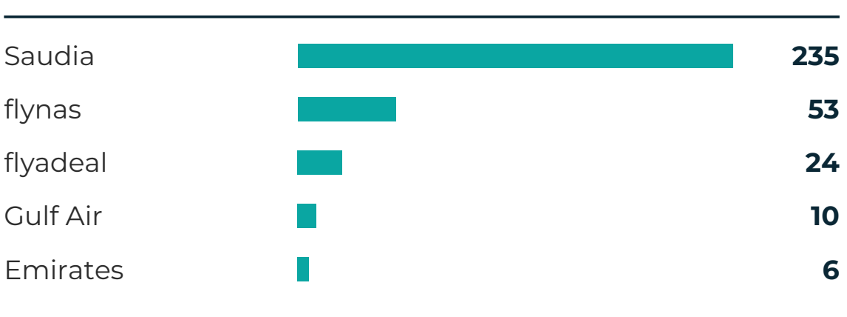
373	4:33 AM	10:49 PM	0	9
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
180 departures + 193 arrivals, 59% of 631 scheduled.	HZA8 to Heraklion (non-airline flight), 1162 min before 11:55 PM. Last airline: SV982, 3:02 AM.	SV993 from Shenzhen, 66 min before 11:55 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Dammam, Jeddah, Qassim.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:55 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 356 at 11:56 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

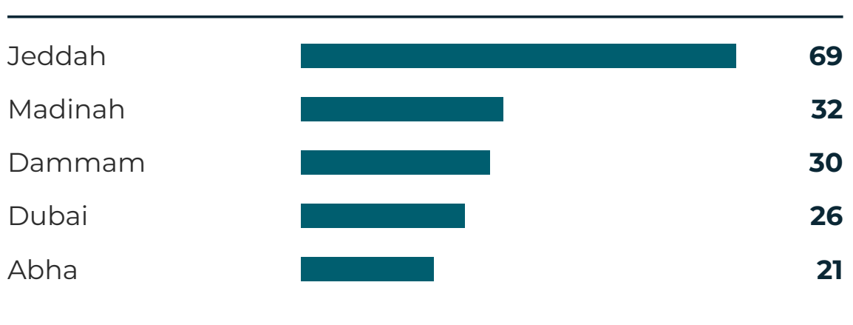
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**180**	**193**	**373**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**170 (53%)**	**186 (60%)**	**356**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**3 (1%)**	**4 (1%)**	**7**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**3 (50%)**	**3 (43%)**	**6**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**0 min**	**0 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**3 of 322**	**2 of 309**	**5 of 631**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**9**	**9**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**47**	**48**	**95**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**175**	**180**	**355**	FR24 stats panel

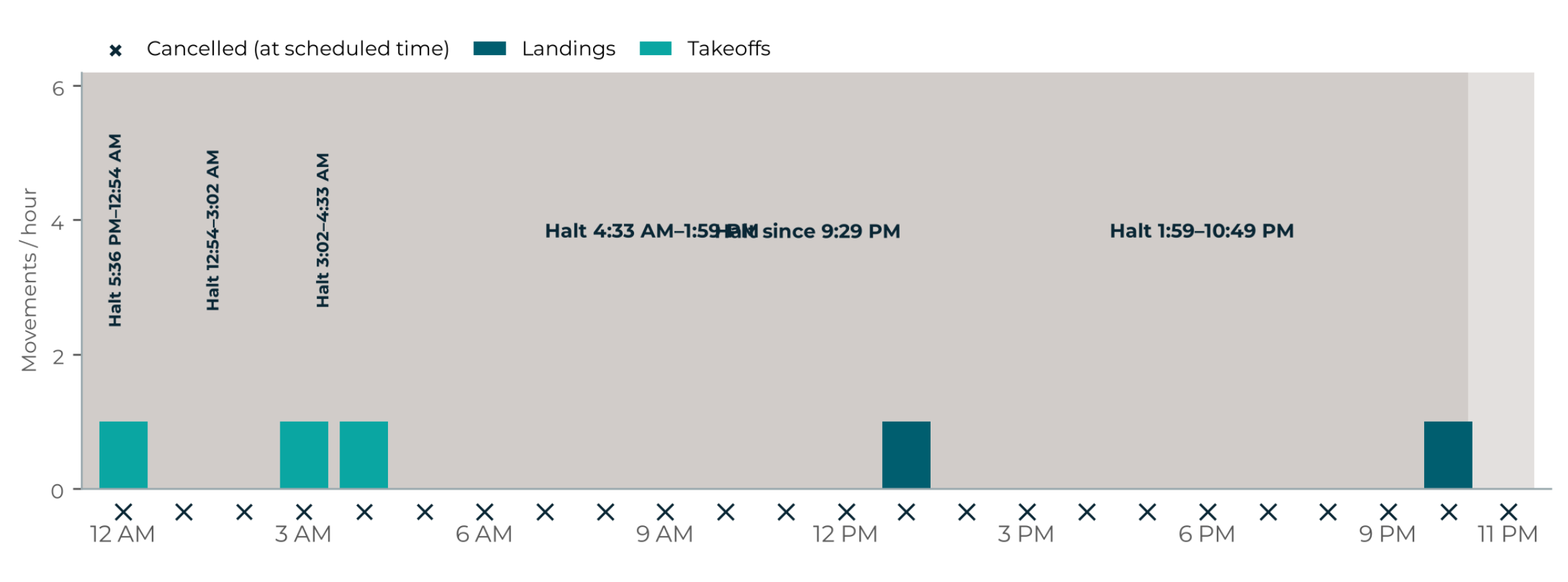
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



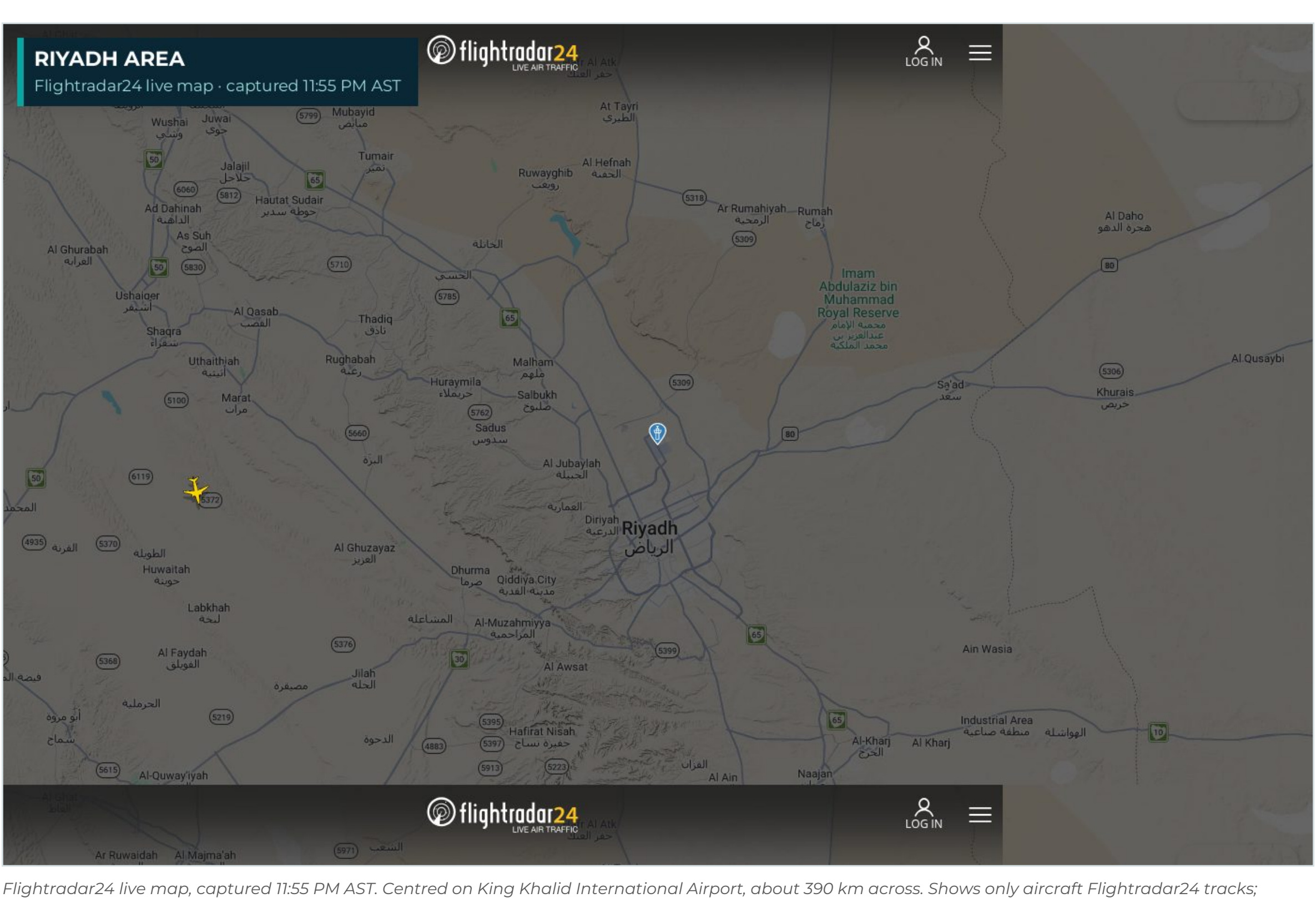
Recorded takeoffs (3) and landings (2) at RUH per hour from 12:00 AM Wednesday to 11:55 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are delayed or non-scheduled flights: Saudia SV982 3:02 AM and HZA8 4:33 AM takeoffs, and HZA8 1:59 PM and Saudia SV993 10:49 PM landings. Dammam's halts in the window ran 1:45–2:55 AM, 3:58–5:59 AM, 8:54–9:48 PM and 9:56–10:55 PM Wednesday.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 1:59–10:49 PM	530 min
Halt 4:33 AM–1:59 PM	566 min
Halt 3:02–4:33 AM	91 min
Halt 12:54–3:02 AM	128 min
Halt 5:36 PM–12:54 AM	438 min

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:55 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. 2 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour.

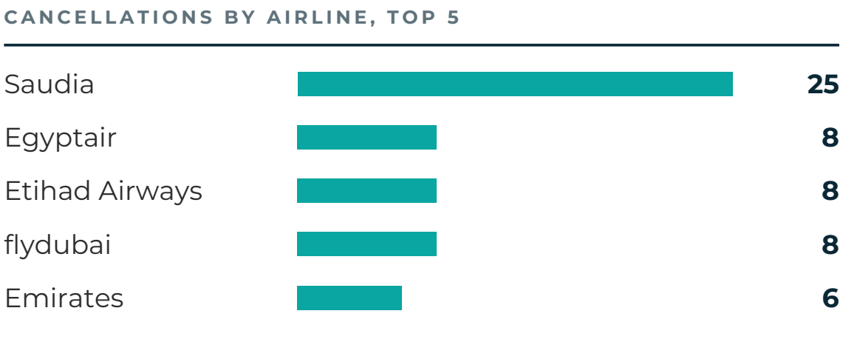
73	11:02 PM	11:17 PM	2	1
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
34 departures + 39 arrivals, 32% of 229 scheduled.	F3318 to Jeddah, 53 min before 11:55 PM.	XY736 from Madinah, 38 min before 11:55 PM.	1 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Bahrain.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:55 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 69 at 11:56 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

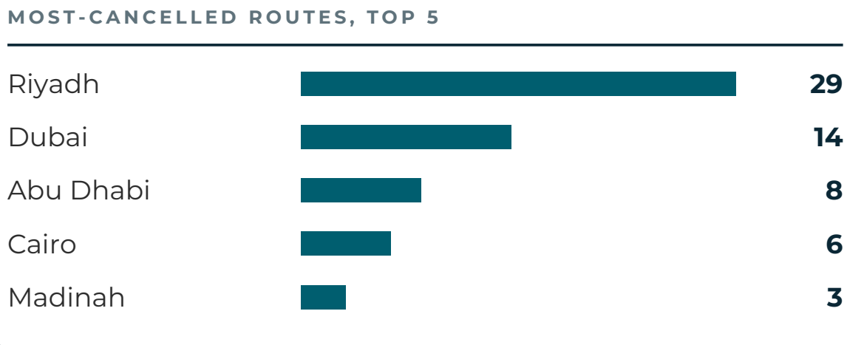
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**34**	**39**	**73**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**32 (27%)**	**37 (32%)**	**69**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**21 (18%)**	**14 (12%)**	**35**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**43 (67%)**	**46 (77%)**	**89**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**71 min**	**38 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**54 of 116**	**54 of 113**	**108 of 229**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**1**	**1**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**16**	**16**	**32**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**32**	**32**	**64**	FR24 stats panel

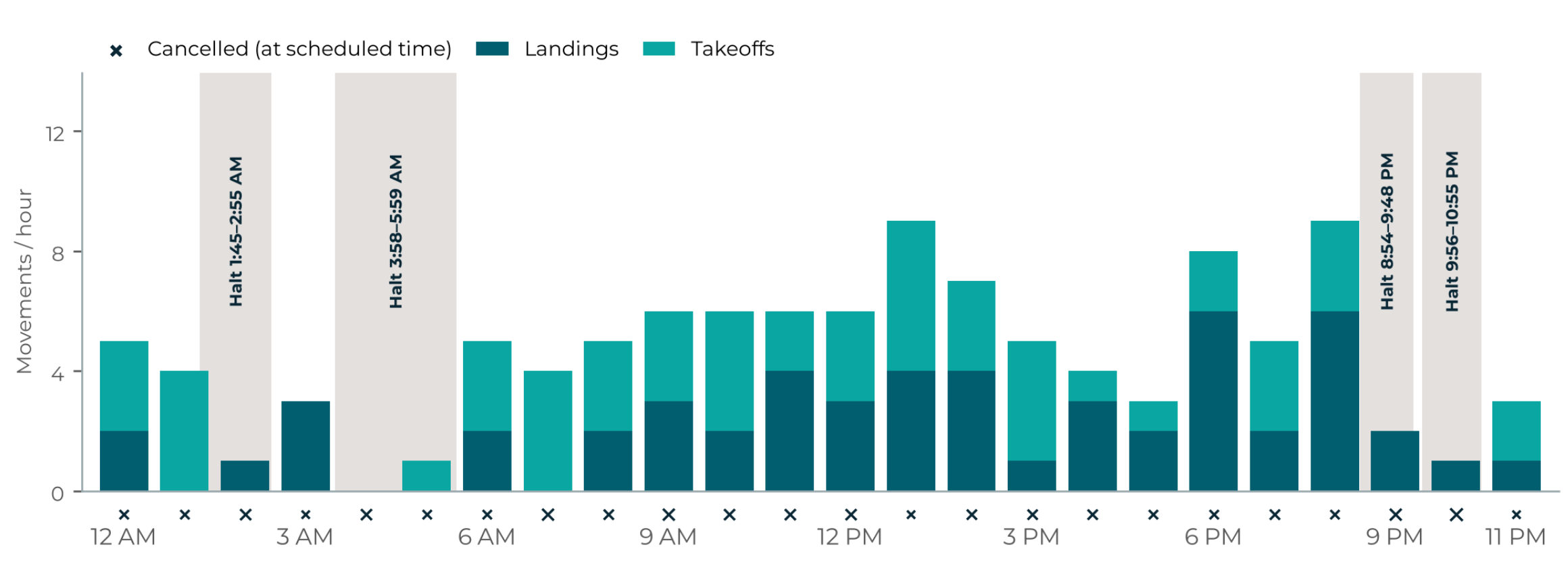
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (54) and landings (54) at DMM per hour from 12:00 AM Wednesday to 11:55 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving after two evening halts (8:54 to 9:48 PM and 9:56 to 10:55 PM); 2 takeoffs and 4 landings since 9:00 PM.

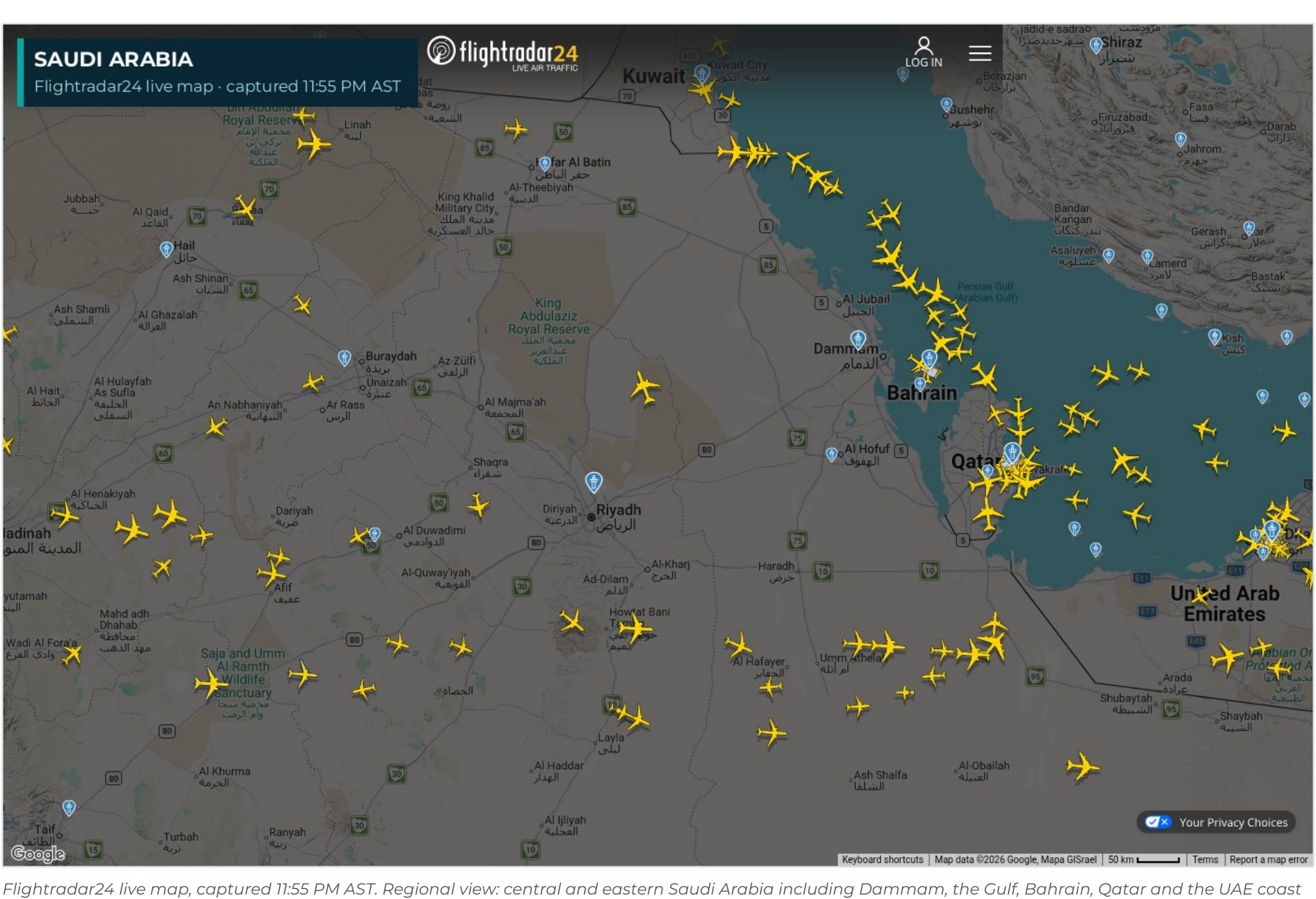
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 9:56–10:55 PM	58 min
Halt 8:54–9:48 PM	54 min
Halt 3:58–5:59 AM	120 min
Halt 1:45–2:55 AM	70 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (11:55 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:55 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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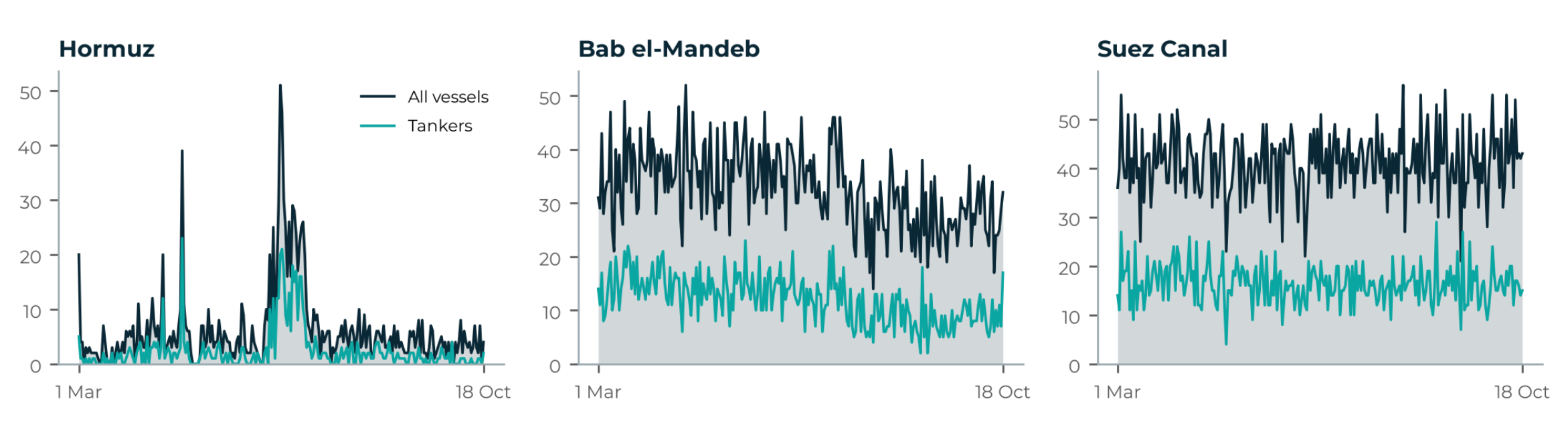
ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

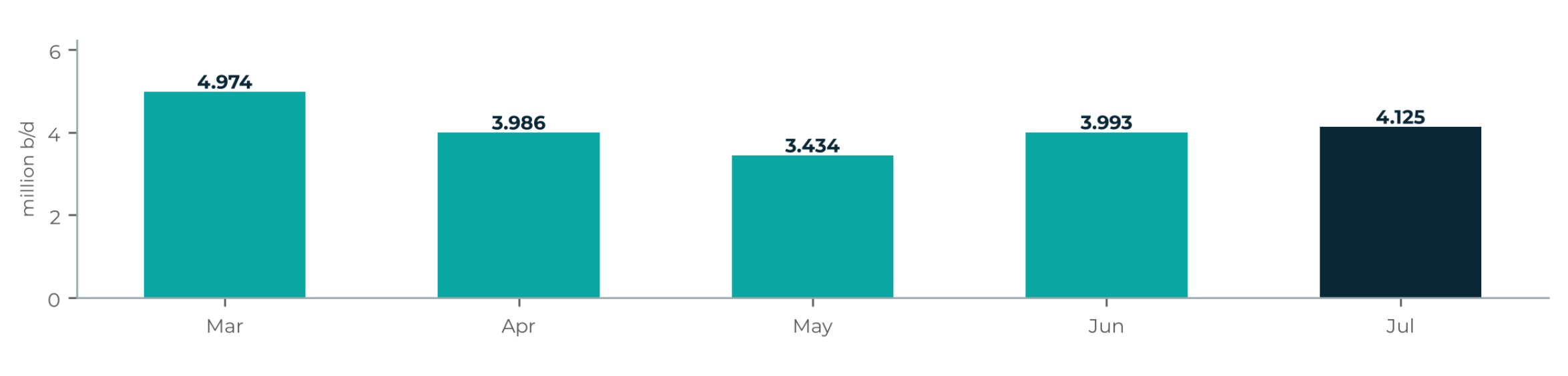
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 18 Oct	**4**	2	2	3.7 (4.1)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 18 Oct	**32**	17	15	26.4 (28.3)
Suez Canal	Sun 18 Oct	**43**	15	28	44.3 (41.7)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 11:56 PM, Wed 21 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

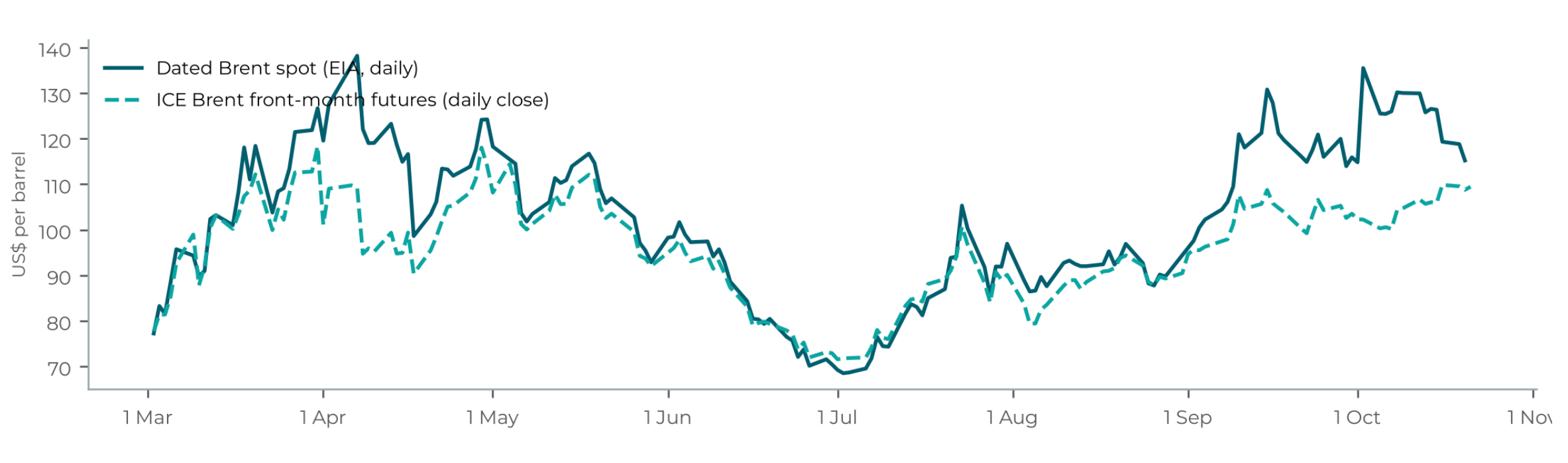


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.45	$115.22	-4%	+49%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 11:46 PM, Wed 21 Oct AST (+0.6% on day). Near real time.	Tue 20 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $119.66 on Fri 18 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

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METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 11:55 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
11:55 PM, Wed 21 Oct	11:55 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted	Open sources · not official	3:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 3:00 AM